

US MARKET INTELLIGENCE | MORNING BRIEFING



JULY 24, 2025

IDEAS & INSIGHTS – IN BRIEF

- **US MKT INTEL** – thoughts on the trading environment. Reiterate our **Tactical Bullish** call.
- **WHITE HOUSE AI ACTION PLAN** – **Josh Meyers** (Tech Sector Spec) gives his view on the directive
- **MEME STOCKS** – **Manish Sinha** (Delta-One, Factor Spec) gives his view on the resurgence of these theme.
- **NIKOS** – Where are market liquidity conditions still impaired?

MORNING UPDATES

- **SPX +0.1%, NDX +0.3%, RTY -0.3%**. WTI +130bps at \$66.10, NatGas +58bps to \$3.10, UK NatGas +56bps to £0.7900, Gold -67bps to \$3,365, Silver -42bps to \$39.10, 10Y @ 4.392%, and VIX @ 15.30.
- **US:** Futs are higher led by Tech with small caps lower after yesterday's outperformance. The AI Theme is driving Tech following GOOG earnings with capex boost helping AVGO/NVDA; TSLA -6% on choppy guidance. Cyclical stronger pre-mkt led by Industrials. Bond yields are 1bp from 2s to 30s with USD seeing its first bid in 5 sessions. Comdty are higher led by Ags/Energy with weakness in both Base/Precious. Today's macro data focus is on Flash PMIs, Jobless Claims, Home Sales, and regional Fed activity indicators.
- **EU/UK:** Major markets are all higher ex-Italy with Spain/UK leading. Regional yield curves are mostly bear flattening with PMIs reflecting stronger Srvcs but flat Mfg; Germany printed below expectations. RU/UKR talks led to talk of a ceasefire, a prisoner swap, and potential mtg of leadership at the end of Aug. The APAC session saw Japan leading with strength in both China/HK. Yield/Domestics are leading, Quality is lagging; Value flat to Growth, Cyclical flat to Defensives. UKX +0.9%, SX5E +0.6%, SXXP +0.5%, DAX +0.8%. CSI +0.7%, HSI +0.5%, NKY +1.6%, ASX -0.3%, KOSPI +0.2%.

CATALYSTS TODAY (WEEK AHEAD)

- **US MACRO DATA:** Chicago Fed Nat Activity Index and Initial/Continuing Jobless Claims at 8:30am ET. **PMI-Mfg, PMI-Srvcs, and PMI-Composite at 9:45am ET.** New Home Sales at 10am ET. Kansas City Fed Mfg Activity at 11am ET. Building Permits (revision).
- **US EARNINGS:** AAL, AMP, **BX**, BYD, CHX, CNP, DAR, DECK, DLR, DOW, EW, FLEX, **HON**, INTC, KDP, LHX, LUV, NDAQ, NEM, POOL, SF, SLM, TRU, TSCO, TXT, **UNP**, VC, VLO, WAB, WST, WY
- **GLOBAL MACRO DATA:** (Germany) GfK Consumer Confidence at 2am ET. (France) Manufacturing Confidence at 2:45am ET. **(France) PMIs at 3:15am ET. (Germany) PMIs at 3:30am ET. (Eurozone) PMIs at 4am ET. (UK) PMIs at 4:30am ET. (Eurozone) ECB at 8:15am ET. (UK) GfK Consumer Confidence at 7:01pm ET. (Japan) Tokyo CPI at 7:30pm ET.**

JPM MARKET INTEL EQUITY & MACRO NARRATIVE

Another day, another record high. With the US / Japan deal announced and the US / EU deal on deck it feels like not even a soft earnings print from a major company can derail this bullish run. That said, today we get a look at the next batch of meaningful macro data ahead of next Friday's NFP print. While Bullishness is not yet consensus, client conversation reveal that even those that skewed bearish are throwing in the towel. The combination of the Momentum Unwind and Meme Mania 2.0 are reducing (eliminating?) people's ability to hold alpha shorts. Combine that with positive comments on M&A pipeline and the impending buyback bid and the storm clouds appear to be lifting ahead of the previously feared Aug 1 deadline. Now, if that US / EU hits the tape, we get a deal from China next week, and the macro data holds up and look for this market to take a significant step higher. If we had this conversation a month ago (or even last week) this would seem like a tail-risk, now it feels like this is the base case.

- **INITIAL JOBLESS CLAIMS – Feroli** sees claims increasing from 221k to 225k, which below the 4-week moving average of 229.5k. The YTD high is 250k.
- **FLASH PMIs – Feroli** sees PMI-Mfg printing 52.0 vs. 52.7 survey; 52.9 prior. He sees PMI-Srvcs printing 53.0 vs. 53.0 survey; 52.9 prior. Feroli notes that last month's MFG print was the highest since 2022 and sees a step down despite stronger Empire Mfg and Philly Fed readings. For Srvcs, sees the index moving sideways despite the potential for tariff escalation to weight on activity.
- **US MKT INTEL – Tactically Bullish.** A hypothesis is based on (i) resilient macro data, (ii) positive earnings growth and (iii) thawing trade rhetoric.

- **MONETIZATION MENU** (repost from July 21 Morning Briefing) – We like longs in MegaCap Tech, Cyclical, and high beta plays. At the country/region-level, we like Australia, China (Tech), and Japan but think the US will outperform RoW in the near-term. We would consider longs in VIX or VIX products as well as SPX puts/put spreads to hedge any near-term downside

WHITE HOUSE'S AI ACTION PLAN – Josh Meyers; a full copy of the action plan is [here](#)

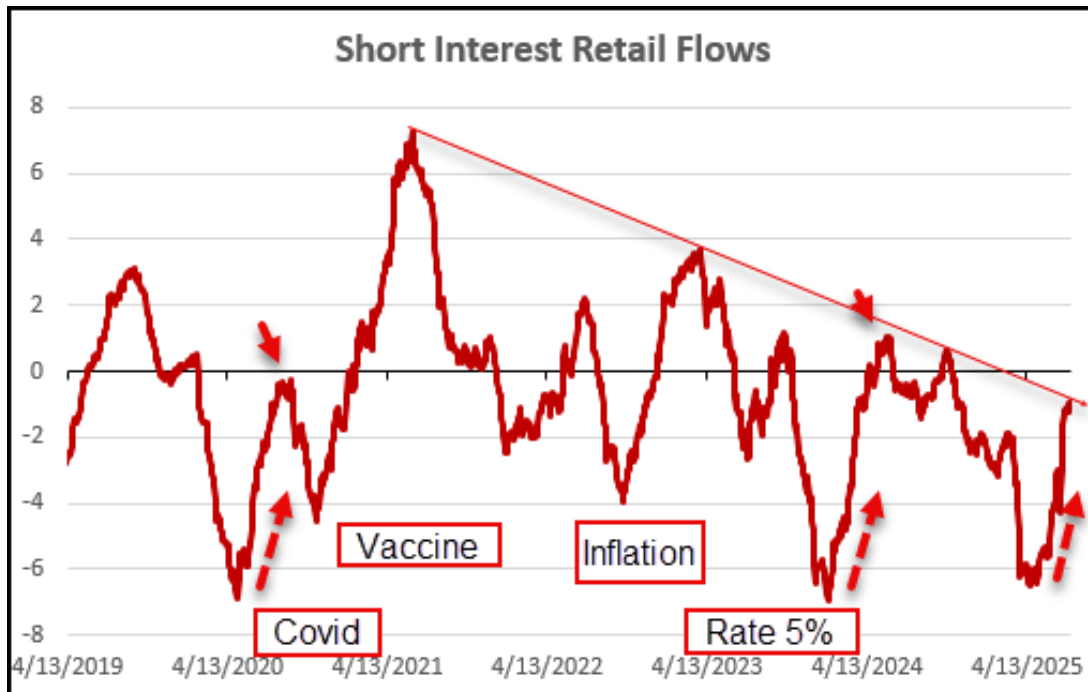
- **BOOST TO DOMESTIC SEMICONDUCTOR PRODUCTION:** 1) Restoration of U.S. Semiconductor Manufacturing (streamlining regulations & reducing policy requirements to drive capital investment in fabs and R&D; sounds like they will reform, not eliminate, CHIPS); 2) Enhanced Export Controls & Supply Chain Security (including plugging gaps in current controls to protect IP, but also meeting global demand for AI by exporting our full AI technology stack - hardware, models, software, applications, and standards - to all countries willing to join our AI alliance).
- **ACCELERATION OF TECH HARDWARE DEMAND & INFRASTRUCTURE UPGRADES:** 1) Investment in AI & DC Infrastructure (build high-security datacenters and a robust AI infrastructure backbone); 2) Expedited Environmental Permitting and Infrastructure Development (shorten timelines and lower costs)
- **SEMI-CAP GROWTH:** 1) Support for AI-Enabling Technologies (emphasizing domestic production, workforce training, and infrastructure investment - including data centers and upgraded electrical grids); 2) Increased Gov't & Trade Support.
- **CHINA:** Pages 20~21 seems to take a hardline on Chinese influence, and to focus on export control - including enhanced monitoring (which China may not like) and exploring "new measures to address gaps in semiconductor manufacturing export controls, coupled with enhanced enforcement" together with our allies ... globally.

MEME STOCKS – Manish Sinha

- Retail buying is showing similarities to 2021 levels, prompting analysis of current patterns. Retail purchases in high short interest stocks may indicate current market behavior.
- Historical instances of similar retail sentiment bounces occurred during COVID and when the 10-year yield hit 5% at the end of 2023.
- In both scenarios, retail buying on short interest stocks recovered to neutral or slightly positive levels. The current squeeze sentiment indicator is comparable to levels seen during the COVID bounce and GME squeezes in 2021. 2021 buying was driven by a new growth cycle due to vaccines and increased COVID-related money supply.

- **Dubravko** notes that the current cycle isn't quite like 2021, but retail bounce levels similar to COVID and rate changes in 2024 are possible.
- Trade deals before August 1st could sustain buying, potentially reaching past levels. August may provide clarity on macroeconomic conditions and trade deals if buying continues.
- **RECOMMENDATION:** Maintain a hedge on Momentum {JPMPURE Index} and negative Beta exposure {JPBPURE Index} until the end of the month.

SHORT INTEREST RETAIL FLOW



Source: JPM Delta-One

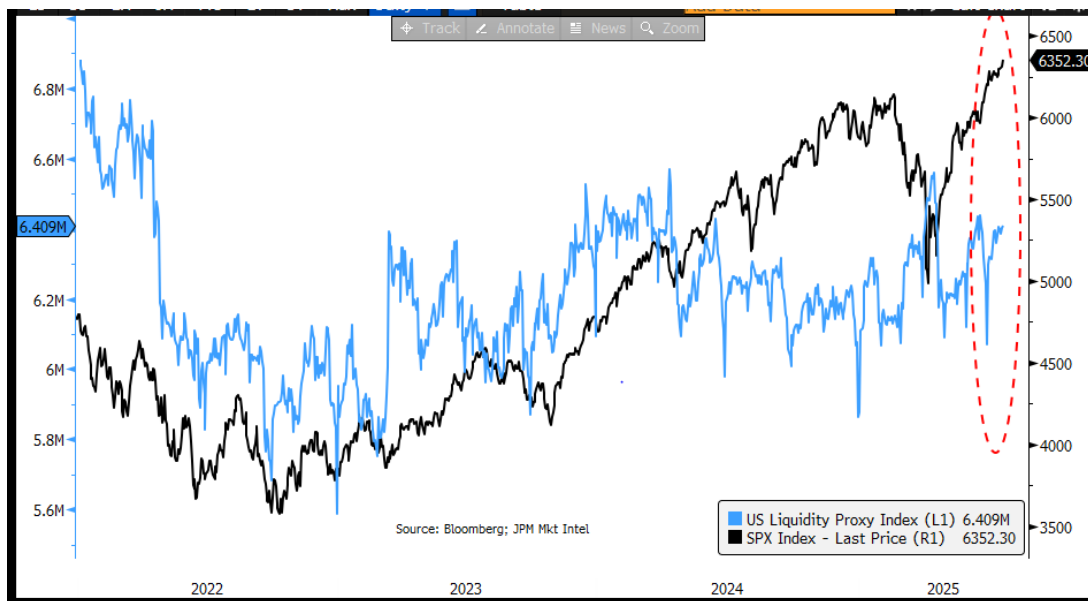
JPM MEME BASKET [JPXXMEME INDEX] vs. SPX vs. NDX



NIKOS: Where are market liquidity conditions still impaired? His full note is [here](#)

- Market liquidity conditions have seen notable improvement for US Equities, 10y Bunds and corporate bond ETFs, remain somewhat impaired for Eurostoxx & Nikkei futures and 10y USTs & JGBs, and have deteriorated for bitcoin & Ethereum futures.
- Why is market vol so low? Despite elevated uncertainty and elevated volatility in economic forecasts and surprises, realized macro volatility (i.e. realized GDP and inflation vol) has been rather subdued since 2023.
- In turn, low realized macro volatility helped to induce low market volatility in conjunction with other factors such as retail investors and corporate buybacks continuing to act as a backstop to drawdowns in Equities, as well as economic and financial leverage overall remaining relatively contained and thus far not served to amplify these shocks.
- Within alternative asset classes, digital assets and hedge funds have been seeing an acceleration of inflows this year, in sharp contrast to the weak fundraising seen in private equity and private credit.
- Hedge funds have produced positive alpha so far in 2025, for a fifth year in a row

US LIQUIDITY PROXY vs. SPX



NEWS LINKS

- EU Sees Progress Toward US Trade Deal With 15% Tariffs ([BBG](#))
- Stocks Climb on US-EU Trade Reports as Bonds Slide ([BBG](#))
- Bessent, Lutnick Hail Japan Finance Pledge in Tariff Deal ([BBG](#))
- Bond Traders Step Up 2026 Fed Cut Bets After Trump Bashes Powell ([BBG](#))
- Japan Trade Deal Offers US Automakers Relief, Not New Markets ([BBG](#))
- June home sales drop as prices hit record high ([CNBC](#))
- Mortgage demand flatlines at low levels, as mortgage rates hit 4-week high ([CNBC](#))
- Institutional landlords see new competition from an unexpected source ([CNBC](#))
- BOJ sees trade deal as raising chance of meeting inflation goal ([RTRS](#))
- UK borrows more as inflation adds to debt bill, and Reeves' headache ([RTRS](#))
- US existing home sales hit nine-month low in June ([RTRS](#))
- Home Prices Hit Record High in June, Dragging Down Sales ([WSJ](#))
- EU Seeks 15% Baseline Tariffs In U.S. Trade Deal ([WSJ](#))
- Trump Administration Pledges to Stimulate AI Use and Exports ([WSJ](#))

WEEKLY ECONOMIC DATA / EARNINGS

US CALENDAR

ECONOMICS

- **JUL 21** – Leading Index at 10am ET.

- **JUL 22** – Philly Fed Non-Mfg Activity at 8:30am ET. Richmond Fed Mfg Index and Business Conditions at 10am ET.
- **JUL 23** – Mortgage Applications at 7am ET. Existing Home Sales at 10am ET.
- **JUL 24** – Chicago Fed Nat Activity Index and Initial/Continuing Jobless Claims at 8:30am ET. **PMI-Mfg, PMI-Srvcs, and PMI-Composite at 9:45am ET.** New Home Sales at 10am ET. Kansas City Fed Mfg Activity at 11am ET. Building Permits (revision).
- **JUL 25** – Durable/Cap Goods Orders at 8:30am ET. Kansas City Fed Services Activity and Bloomberg July United States Economic Survey at 11am ET.

EARNINGS (JPM US Earnings Calendar [here](#); US Analyst Focus List [here](#))

- **JUL 21** – AGNC, ARE, CLF, DPZ, MEDP, ROP, **VZ**
- **JUL 22** – BKR, **COF**, CRCL, CSGP, DGX, DHI, **DHR**, EFX, ENPH, EQT, GM, HAL, IPG, IQV, **ISRG**, IVZ, KEY, **KO**, **LMT**, MSCI, NOC, PCAR, PEGA, PHM, **PM**, **RTX**, SHW, SYF, THC, **TXN**, VBTX
- **JUL 23** – **APH**, **BSX**, CCI, CME, CMG, COOP, CSX, FAF, FCX, FI, GD, **GEV**, **GOOGL**, HAS, HLT, **IBM**, KNX, LII, LVS, LW, MCO, MOH, **NEE**, NLY, **NOW**, NTRS, ORLY, OTIS, QS, SEI, T, TDY, **TMO**, **TMUS**, **TSLA**, URI, VKTX
- **JUL 24** – AAL, AMP, **BX**, BYD, CHX, CNP, DAR, DECK, DLR, DOW, EW, FLEX, **HON**, INTC, KDP, LHX, LUV, NDAQ, NEM, POOL, SF, SLM, TRU, TSCO, TXT, **UNP**, VC, VLO, WAB, WST, WY
- **JUL 25** – BAH, CHTR, CNC, FIX, FLG, HCA, PSX, ROG, SAIA, SKX, XRX

SPX 2025 Q2 EARNINGS CALENDAR													
% SECTOR RPTG													
Start	End	SPX	TECH	HC	FIN	DISCR	INDU	TELS	STAPLS	ENERGY	UTIL	MATR	RE
14-Jul	18-Jul	10%	0%	11%	42%	0%	12%	11%	6%	6%	0%	0%	8%
21-Jul	25-Jul	16%	6%	14%	11%	25%	29%	32%	18%	11%	13%	26%	15%
28-Jul	1-Aug	38%	50%	25%	25%	47%	28%	34%	25%	44%	43%	48%	52%
4-Aug	8-Aug	11%	6%	27%	4%	9%	20%	7%	3%	29%	36%	17%	16%
11-Aug	15-Aug	1%	3%	1%	0%	0%	3%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
18-Aug	22-Aug	3%	4%	1%	0%	12%	0%	0%	14%	0%	0%	0%	0%
25-Aug	29-Aug	9%	30%	0%	0%	1%	0%	0%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%
1-Sep	5-Sep	3%	9%	0%	0%	0%	1%	0%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%

Source: Bloomberg, JPM US Market Intelligenc data as of 7/17/2025

GLOBAL CALENDAR

- **JUL 21** – (Canada) IP at 8:30am ET.

- **JUL 22** – (UK) Public Finances at 2am ET.
- **JUL 23** – **(Eurozone) Consumer Confidence at 10am ET. (Japan) PMIs at 8:30pm ET.**
- **JUL 24** – (Germany) GfK Consumer Confidence at 2am ET. (France) Manufacturing Confidence at 2:45am ET. **(France) PMIs at 3:15am ET. (Germany) PMIs at 3:30am ET. (Eurozone) PMIs at 4am ET. (UK) PMIs at 4:30am ET. (Eurozone) ECB at 8:15am ET. (UK) GfK Consumer Confidence at 7:01pm ET. (Japan) Tokyo CPI at 7:30pm ET.**
- **JUL 25** – (UK) Retail Sales at 2am ET. (France) Consumer Confidence at 2:45am ET. (Germany) IFO Business Climate at 4am ET.

NEAR TERM CATALYSTS – CPI (Aug 12, Sep 11), ISM-Mfg (Aug 1, Sep 2), ISM-Srvcs (Aug 5, Sep 4), PMI-Mfg (Jul 24, Aug 21), PMI-Srvcs (Jul 24, Aug 21), NFP (Aug 1, Sep 5), PCE (Aug 29, Sep 26), Retail Sales (Aug 15, Sep 16). **FED DATES**: Jul 30, Sep 17; Jackson Hole Aug 21-23.

POLITICAL CATALYSTS

- **JUL 24-25** – EU-China Summit ([POLITICO](#))
- **JUL 27-30** – US-China Trade Talk
- **JUL 31** – Oral argument of IEEPA tariff case appeal.
- **AUG 1** – New tariff deadline announced by Trump for the countries to negotiate new trade agreements.
- **AUG 12** – The 90-day China tariff pause ends.
- **OCT 18** – JCPOA (Iran nuclear deal) is set to expire.

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